

Yutong (Max) Zhu

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EDUCATION	University of Chicago <i>Ph.D., Sociology</i>	Chicago, IL <i>Expected 2031</i>
	University of Chicago <i>M.A., Computational Social Science</i>	Chicago, IL <i>Jun 2025</i>
	Carnegie Mellon University <i>B.S. (University Honors), Computer Science; Additional Major in History</i>	Pittsburgh, PA <i>May 2022</i>
PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES	≡ indicates equal contribution and shared first authorship.	
	[2] Sui, Peiqi [≡] , Yutong Zhu [≡] , Tianyi Cheng, Peter West, Richard Jean So, Hoyt Long, and Ari Holtzman. Spoiler Alert: Narrative Forecasting as a Metric for Tension in LLM Storytelling. Conference on Language Modeling (COLM) 2026. [Preprint].	
	[1] Zhu, Yutong . Explaining Gendered Language Through Embedding Approximation: How “Stupid” Became a Man’s Word. <i>Forthcoming at Social Forces</i> . [DOI]	
PAPERS UNDER REVIEW	[1] Li, Zehan, Yutong Zhu , Siyang Wu, Honglin Bao, and James A. Evans. Narrative Flattening: How Post-Training Compresses Thematic, Affective, and Stylistic Variation in LLM Fiction. In submission. [Preprint].	
WORKS IN PROGRESS	[2] Zhu, Yutong , Tianyi Zhang, Junsol Kim, Aaron Schein, and James Evans. The Zeitgeist Machine: Partisan Opinion Landscapes from Language Model Activations. <i>Manuscript in preparation</i> .	
	[1] Rochelle Terman, Shilin Jia, Yutong Zhu , and James Evans. The Nations in Our Minds: Historical Representations of Countries in Google Books. <i>Manuscript in preparation</i> .	
PRESENTATIONS	Explaining Gendered Language Through Embedding Approximation: How “Stupid” Became a Man’s Word - American Sociological Association (ASA) Annual Meeting 2025, Section Session The Nations in Our Minds: Historical Representations of Countries in Google Books - International Studies Association (ISA) Annual Convention 2025, Regular Session Between Min and Zu: Ethnonym and National Narrative in Post-Imperial China - Midwest Conference on Asian Affairs (MCAA) 2024, Regular Session	
HONORS & AWARDS	University Scholar Full-Tuition Scholarship , University of Chicago, 2023–2025 Ludwig Schaefer Award for Outstanding Achievement in History , Carnegie Mellon University, 2022 Dietrich College Senior Honors Fellowship , Carnegie Mellon University, 2021	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	University of Chicago - Large-Scale Computing for the Social Sciences (Spring 2025), Dr. Jon Clindaniel, Dr. Fabricio Vasselai - Perspectives on Computational Modeling (Winter 2025), Dr. Zhao Wang	

PROFESSIONAL
EXPERIENCE

Journal of Asian Studies
Editorial Assistant (Part-Time)

Remote
Mar 2023 – Jun 2025

Stellar Cyber
Data Engineer

San Jose, CA
Jun 2022 – Feb 2023

SKILLS

Methods: Data Management, Quantitative & Qualitative Research, Academic Writing, Data Analysis & Pipeline, Machine Learning, NLP

Technical: Python, C, Java, SPARQL, SQL, Kubernetes, Git; Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign

Languages: Mandarin (native), French (intermediate), Uzbek (elementary)

REFERENCES

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